

A Gymnich meeting is an informal meeting of the foreign ministers of the member states of the European Union, organized every six months according to the rotating Presidency of the Council of the European Union since 1974. The ministers are not accompanied by their assistants, which makes the environment easier for informal and frank exchanges of views. This type of meeting received its name from the first of such events held at Schloss Gymnich in Erftstadt, North Rhine-Westphalia, Germany, owned by the Kelly Family.

Meetings

2026

Lemesos (Cyprus): 27 and 28 May

Wicklow (Ireland): 1 and 2 September

2025

Warsaw: 7 and 8 May

Copenhagen: 30 August

2024

Brussels (Egmont Palace): 2 and 3 February

Brussels: 29 August*

*Hungary held the Presidency in the second half of 2024, and wanted to organise a meeting in Budapest on this date. High Representative Borell decided to organise an informal meeting in Brussels as a "punishment for Hungary misusing the presidency", due to Hungarian Prime Minister Orban visiting Moscow and Beijing amid the Russian war in Ukraine.

2023

Stockholm: 12 and 13 May

Toledo: 29 and 30 August

2022

Prague: 30 and 31 August

Brest: 13 and 14 January

2021

Lisbon (Portugal): 4 March.

Kranj (Slovenia): 2 and 3 September.

2020

Lužnica Castle (Croatia): 5 March.

Berlin: 27 and 28 August

2019

Bucharest: 31 January–1 February

Helsinki: 29–30 August

2018

Sofia: 15–16 February

Vienna: 30–31 August

2017

Valletta: 28 April

Tallinn: 7–8 September

2016

Amsterdam: 5–6 February

Bratislava: 2–3 September

2015

Riga: 6–7 March

Luxembourg: 4–5 September

2012

Aphrodite Hills Resort, Pafos: 7 and 8 September

See also

Foreign Affairs Council

References

Further reading

Patrick Roger, « La très couteuse présidence française de l'Union européenne », *Le Monde*, 2009-10-29

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Clifford P. Hackett: "Cautious Revolution: The European Union Arrives" ISBN 0313295271 p. 175

Christopher Hill, Karen Elizabeth Smith: "European Foreign Policy: Key Documents" ISBN 0415158222 p. 97

Jeremy John Richardson: "European Union: Power and Policy-making" ISBN 0415358140 p. 154